Business Travel, Expenses & Procurement Policy

Bookings, reimbursement limits, approvals, and purchasing

Document ID	04_TRAVEL_EXPENSE_AND_PROCUREMENT
Version	3.0
Effective date	01 August 2026
Document owner	Finance Operations
Classification	Internal – Fictional training content

Purpose

This controlled document contains invented company-specific facts, rules, limits, names, and procedures. It is designed to be ingested into a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) system so that answers can be grounded in source documents rather than model assumptions.

1. Scope and general rules

• This policy applies to employees travelling or spending on behalf of Asterion Works. Contractors follow the terms of their services agreement.

• Expenses must be necessary, reasonable, supported by valid evidence, and incurred for an approved business purpose.

• Personal expenses, expenses for family members, traffic fines, minibar purchases, and leisure upgrades are not reimbursable.

• Employees must not split a purchase or claim to avoid an approval threshold.

2. Travel approval

• All overnight travel requires manager approval before booking.

• International travel requires approval from the department head and Finance Operations, in addition to the manager.

• Travel requests should be submitted at least 7 calendar days before domestic travel and 21 calendar days before international travel.

• Emergency travel may be booked sooner with written manager approval and a brief explanation attached to the expense claim.

3. Booking standards

Domestic flights: Economy class. Book at least 7 days in advance where practical. A refundable fare may be selected when the meeting date is uncertain, with manager approval.

International flights: Economy class for journeys under 6 hours. Premium economy may be approved by the department head for journeys of 6 hours or more. Business class is not reimbursable under the standard policy.

Rail: AC 2-tier or equivalent for domestic overnight journeys. AC chair car is permitted for journeys under 6 hours.

Hotel: INR 7,500 per night in Bengaluru, Mumbai, Delhi, and Singapore; INR 6,000 per night in other approved domestic cities. Singapore limit is SGD 180 per night, not INR 7,500.

Ground transport: Use company-preferred providers where available. App-based cab rides are allowed with itemised receipts. Self-drive rentals require manager approval.

4. Meals and incidentals

• Domestic meal allowance is INR 1,200 per full travel day. On a partial travel day, the limit is INR 600.

• International meal allowance is USD 45 per full travel day, converted at the card settlement rate. Singapore trips use the same USD-denominated cap.

• Meal allowance includes tips and non-alcoholic beverages. Alcohol is never reimbursable.

• Meals provided by a conference, hotel, or customer must be deducted from the daily allowance: breakfast INR 200, lunch INR 400, dinner INR 400 for domestic travel.

• Client entertainment requires advance approval from the department head and must list attendees, organisation, and business purpose.

5. Expense submission and reimbursement

• Claims must be submitted in FinanceDesk within 15 calendar days after the trip ends or the expense is incurred, whichever is later.

• Receipts are mandatory for individual expenses above INR 500. For foreign-currency transactions, attach the original receipt and card statement line.

• Claims submitted after 15 days require a written explanation and Finance Operations approval. Claims more than 60 days late are rejected unless the CFO approves an exception.

• Approved claims are paid in the next two payroll cycles. Rejected claims include a reason code and may be resubmitted within 7 calendar days if corrected.

• Employees must not claim a per diem and the same meal as an itemised reimbursement.

6. Travel advances and cancellations

• Travel advances are available only for trips expected to exceed INR 20,000 in reimbursable costs.

• Advance requests must be submitted at least 5 business days before departure. The advance must be reconciled within 10 calendar days after return.

• Unused advances must be returned to Finance Operations within 5 business days after reconciliation.

• Cancellation credits and airline vouchers belong to Asterion when the original ticket was company-funded. Employees must not use company-funded credits for personal travel.

7. Procurement and purchase orders

• Any software, equipment, or service purchase above INR 25,000 requires a purchase request and purchase order before commitment.

• Purchases from INR 25,001 to INR 2,00,000 require manager and Finance Operations approval.

• Purchases above INR 2,00,000 require department-head and Finance Director approval.

• Any recurring software subscription requires IT Security review before purchase, regardless of price.

• Employees may not sign vendor terms, click-through enterprise agreements, or commit Asterion to auto-renewal without Legal review.

• Emergency purchases below INR 10,000 may be reimbursed with manager approval and a written explanation. This exception does not apply to software subscriptions.

8. Examples and edge cases

• Example: A domestic trip lasts 2 full days and one partial day. The meal cap is INR 3,000 before deductions for meals provided.

• Example: A hotel in Singapore is subject to the SGD 180 nightly limit. Do not convert the domestic Bengaluru cap into a Singapore allowance.

• Example: A INR 30,000 monitor requires a purchase order; an employee should not buy it personally and seek reimbursement.

• Example: A taxi receipt of INR 420 does not require a receipt under the general INR 500 threshold, but the trip purpose and date must still be recorded.

• Example: A INR 900 meal requires a receipt and must fit within the applicable daily meal allowance.

9. Policy ownership

• Finance Operations owns reimbursement interpretation. The CFO is the final approver for exceptions to monetary limits.

• Department heads cannot waive tax documentation or procurement controls.

• Where local tax law requires additional documentation, the stricter legal requirement applies.

End of document — Questions should be routed to the document owner listed above. If the answer is not stated here or in another applicable controlled document, say that the knowledge base does not specify it.